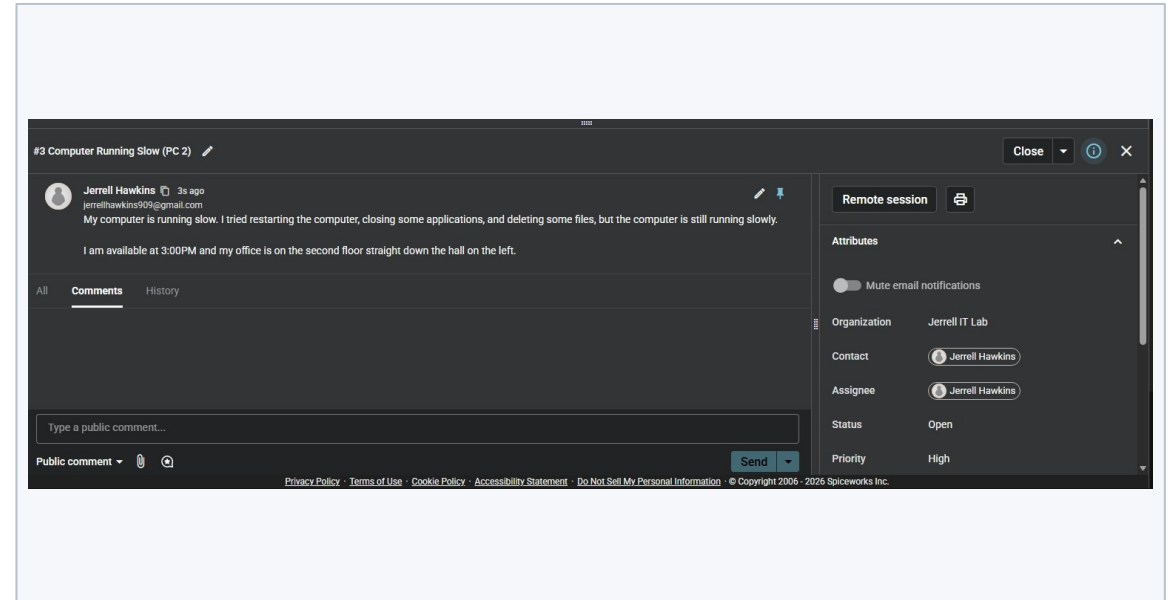


Spiceworks Help Desk Ticketing Lab

Simulated Service-Desk Workflow

Jerrell Hawkins

Ticket intake | Troubleshooting | User communication | Resolution | Escalation



Lab objective

Practice the complete support lifecycle: capture the problem, document work, communicate clearly, resolve when possible, and escalate with useful evidence.

The Lab Simulated the Work Behind a Tier 1 Ticket Queue

Environment

Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk configured as Jerrell IT Lab with simulated requester, technician, and assignee roles.

Workflow

Created and categorized tickets, recorded user details, added public updates and internal notes, and documented outcomes.

Scenarios

Slow workstation, failed printer output, and loss of access to a department shared drive.

Support judgment

Resolved a known printer condition and recognized when a shared-drive issue required escalation beyond basic troubleshooting.

I Captured the Issue and the User's First Actions

#3 Computer Running Slow (PC 2)

Jerrell Hawkins 3s ago
jerrellhawkins909@gmail.com
My computer is running slow. I tried restarting the computer, closing some applications, and deleting some files, but the computer is still running slowly.

I am available at 3:00PM and my office is on the second floor straight down the hall on the left.

All Comments History

Type a public comment...

Public comment Send

Privacy Policy · Terms of Use · Cookie Policy · Accessibility Statement · Do Not Sell My Personal Information · © Copyright 2006 - 2026 Spiceworks Inc.

Remote session

Attributes

Mute email notifications

Organization Jerrell IT Lab

Contact Jerrell Hawkins

Assignee Jerrell Hawkins

Status Open

Priority High

What good intake provides

- A searchable, specific summary.
- The user's symptoms and attempted fixes.
- Contact and scheduling details.
- Ownership, category, status, and priority fields.
- Enough context to begin troubleshooting without repeating questions.

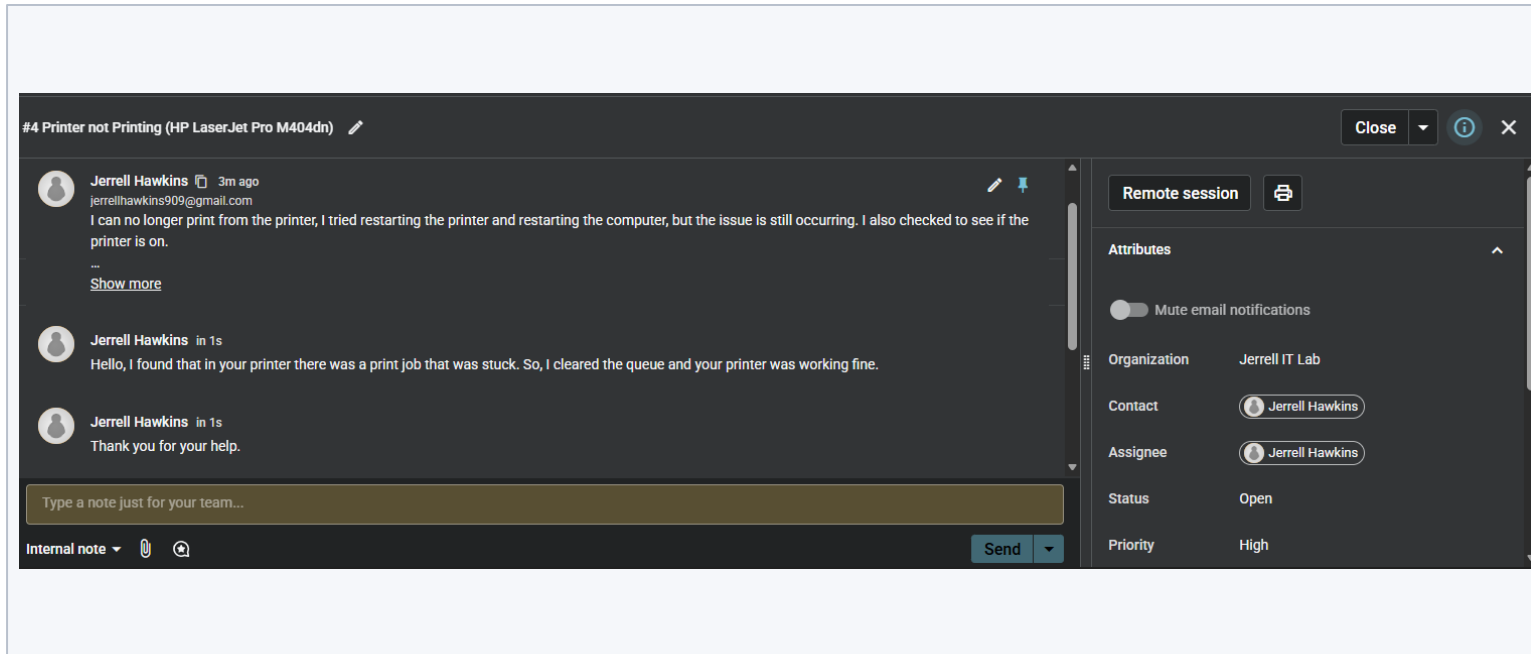
Ticket #3: Computer Running Slow

The request records the symptom, steps already attempted, user availability, and physical location. The ticket is assigned, categorized as Hardware, and left Open for investigation.

Triage standard

Priority should reflect business impact and urgency. A single slow PC is not automatically high priority.

I Documented the Printer Resolution



Support behaviors shown

- Replied in the ticket instead of using an undocumented side channel.
- Explained the root cause without unnecessary info.
- Recorded the corrective action and restored service.
- Received user acknowledgment before final closure.

Public update

The response explains the cause in plain language: a stuck print job was cleared from the queue and printing resumed. The requester then acknowledged the help.

Evidence note

The screenshot still displays Status: Open. It proves the resolution was documented, but not that the status was changed to Closed.

I Separated Technical Notes From the Public Conversation

The screenshot displays a Spiceworks ticket management interface. At the top, a table lists several tickets. Ticket #4, titled 'Printer not Printing (HP LaserJet Pro M404dn)', is selected. Below the table, the ticket details are shown. On the left, a public conversation thread is visible, with a message from Jerrell Hawkins stating that the printer is not working and that he has tried restarting it. On the right, a sidebar contains a 'Remote session' button, a 'Mute email notifications' toggle, and fields for 'Organization' (Jerrell IT Lab), 'Contact' (Jerrell Hawkins), 'Assignee' (Jerrell Hawkins), 'Status' (Open), and 'Priority' (High). At the bottom, there is a text input field for an 'Internal note' and a 'Send' button.

ID	Summary	Assignee	Creator	Organization	Priority	Category	Status	Created	Updated	Due Date	Response Time
4	Printer not Printing (HP LaserJet Pro M404dn)	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell IT Lab	High	Printer	Open	3m ago	3m ago		
3	Computer Running Slow (PC 2)	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell IT Lab	High	Hardware	Open	7m ago	7m ago		
2	Import tickets from your previous Spiceworks ...	Accept	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell IT Lab	Medium		Open	29m ago	29m ago		
1	Welcome to the Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk!	Accept	Jerrell Hawkins	Jerrell IT Lab	Medium		Open	29m ago	29m ago		

#4 Printer not Printing (HP LaserJet Pro M404dn)

Jerrell Hawkins 3m ago
jerrellhawkins909@gmail.com
I can no longer print from the printer, I tried restarting the printer and restarting the computer, but the issue is still occurring. I also checked to see if the printer is on.
...
[Show more](#)

Jerrell Hawkins in 1s
The troubleshooting steps taken:
Verified the printer was on
Confirmed the computer was connected to the network
Made sure this printer was set to the default printer
Checked the windows print queue and found a stuck print job
Cancelled the stuck print job and printed a test print

Type a note just for your team...

Internal note Send

Remote session

Attributes

☐ Mute email notifications

Organization Jerrell IT Lab

Contact

Assignee

Status Open

Priority High

Internal note captured

- Verified the printer was powered on.
- Confirmed the workstation had network connectivity.
- Checked that the correct printer was set as default.
- Inspected the Windows print queue and found a stuck job.
- Canceled the job and completed a test print.

Result: A repeatable record of what was checked, what was found, and what fixed the incident.

Why internal notes matter

It makes it easier for another technician without exposing unnecessary technical detail to the requester.

I Documented the Limits of Tier 1 Troubleshooting

The screenshot displays a Spiceworks ticketing system interface. At the top, there is a table listing several tickets. Ticket #5, titled 'Unable to Access Department Shared Drive', is highlighted. Below the table, the details for Ticket #5 are shown. The ticket is assigned to Jerrell Hawkins, created 5s ago, and is of High priority. The description states: 'I tried to access the accounting departments shared drive, and it was working fine yesterday, but when I try to open it this morning it didn't work. I tried restarting the computer, and I asked another employee if they had an issue, but they were able to access the shared drive.' Below this, a response from Jerrell Hawkins is shown: 'Ok thank you.' A large yellow box contains the following text: 'Troubleshooting steps taken: I made sure there was a network connection I restarted the computer I checked the shared drive path to see if they were accessing the correct network Now I'm escalating the ticket since basic troubleshooting steps did not fix the issue'. At the bottom, there is a text input field for an internal note, a 'Send' button, and a dropdown menu for the note type (currently set to 'Internal note').

Ticket #5: Department Shared Drive

- Confirmed the workstation had network connectivity.
- Restarted the computer.
- Verified the shared-drive path and target network.
- Compared impact with another employee who could still connect.
- Recorded that basic troubleshooting did not resolve the issue.

Escalation decision

The evidence supports preparing a higher-tier handoff because the issue persisted and appeared isolated to one user's access or permissions.

Evidence boundary: The internal note says the ticket will be escalated, but the screenshot does not show reassignment to another technician or support group.

A Consistent Lifecycle Guided Every Ticket

01

Intake

Capture symptoms, impact, requester details, and prior attempts.

02

Triage

Set category, owner, status, and priority from impact and urgency.

03

Work

Troubleshoot methodically and document technical findings internally.

04

Finish

Resolve and confirm with the user, or escalate with a complete handoff.

Core principle

A useful ticket tells the next technician what happened without requiring the user to start over.

Future Project Improvement's

Impact-based priority

Use urgency and business impact instead of assigning every incident High priority.

Complete closure proof

Capture the final Closed or Resolved status after confirming service with the requester.

Clear role separation

Use distinct requester and technician test accounts so the conversation mirrors a real service desk.

Visible escalation handoff

Show the new assignee or support group, reason for escalation, completed checks, and expected next action.

What I Learned from the Lab

Ticket quality

How a precise summary, structured fields, and complete description improve ownership and response time.

Technical documentation

How internal notes create a reusable troubleshooting history and support a smooth technician handoff.

Customer communication

How to acknowledge symptoms, explain a fix plainly, and keep the requester informed through the ticket.

Escalation judgment

How to recognize the limits of Tier 1 support and escalate only after recording completed checks and results.

Summary

Spiceworks Help Desk Ticketing Lab | Simulated Environment

- Created and managed simulated support tickets in Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk for workstation performance, printer, and shared-drive access incidents.
- Documented requester symptoms, prior actions, troubleshooting steps, technical findings, public updates, and internal technician notes throughout the ticket lifecycle.
- Resolved a printer issue by identifying and clearing a stuck print job, then prepared a shared-drive incident for escalation after basic troubleshooting did not restore access.

Skills: Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk, ticket intake, incident documentation, troubleshooting, customer communication, ticket resolution, escalation